

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

What is in store for the ASOIAF/GoT Fandom after the end of Thrones, Indian science fiction TV shows, some cool stuff to pick up if you invested in Bitcoin ten years ago, and the big pop culture releases lined up.



Know your type

Letters are complex creatures made up of bowls, shoulders, loops, tails, beaks, arms, feet, spurs, spines and hairlines. If you cannot point out these parts, then this interactive typography cheat sheet should totally sort you out. <https://dgit.in/typeanat>

WHAT'S NEW

Why it is ethical to wear leather and fur

Animal rights activists have advocated avoiding wearing clothes sourced from animals. Top fashion brands for example, are avoiding silk, fur or leather based clothing. The simplified moral choice here is that an animal is not killed so that you get to wear what you do. By not choosing "cruel" clothing, we are polluting the environment, as the cost of manufacturing synthetic apparel also needs to be factored in. Synthetic clothing manufacturing depends heavily on petrochemicals, which introduces pollutants to the air and water, and contributes to climate change as well. For example, just one nylon factory in England was responsible for three percent of the carbon



emissions of the country, in 2013. Every time an item of polyester clothing is washed, microplastics are introduced to the water cycle, which then enters the food cycle. The solution is to buy fewer clothes, and maintain them, instead of avoiding leather, silk or fur. <https://dgit.in/furethics>

Is the school system broken?

This is one of those incredibly interesting questions that not too many people have bothered to ask. Every day, students go into a high school, and learn a variety of subjects broken down into short periods. This is an ancient system that has never been updated to modern standards. Imagine if adults were expected to actually work at offices in this manner, focus on task or assignment for a short time, then move on to

another significantly different task. The productivity of each individual, and the company



as a whole would fall through the ground. Why should the expectations from high school

students be any different? Bernie Bleske, the author of a medium post that asks this question proposes a solution where there are two long classes - or two subjects every day for six to eight weeks. This will allow a focussed transfer of knowledge, instead of a fragmented approach where a range of topics are covered every day, but sacrificing the depth for each subject. <https://dgit.in/absurdhs>



All hipsters look the same

A hipster sued MIT for using a picture of him without permission in an article about how all non conformists end up looking the same, only to find out later that the person in the picture - a white man with a beard, a checked shirt and a beanie, was an entirely different hipster. <https://dgit.in/hipstereffect>



How Random are you?

This is a simple exercise which involves making a single choice - either left or right. An algorithm then tries to outsmart you by predicting your next move, based on your previous five keypresses. Surprisingly, the algorithm manages to outguess most respondents. <https://dgit.in/randomo>



The Servant Economy

Uber heralded in a new business model, where there is an "Uber" app for everything from food delivery to dog walking. The net benefit to society is that they make life marginally more convenient for a few people. The workforce of these apps don't have jobs, but only land gigs. <https://dgit.in/gigeco>